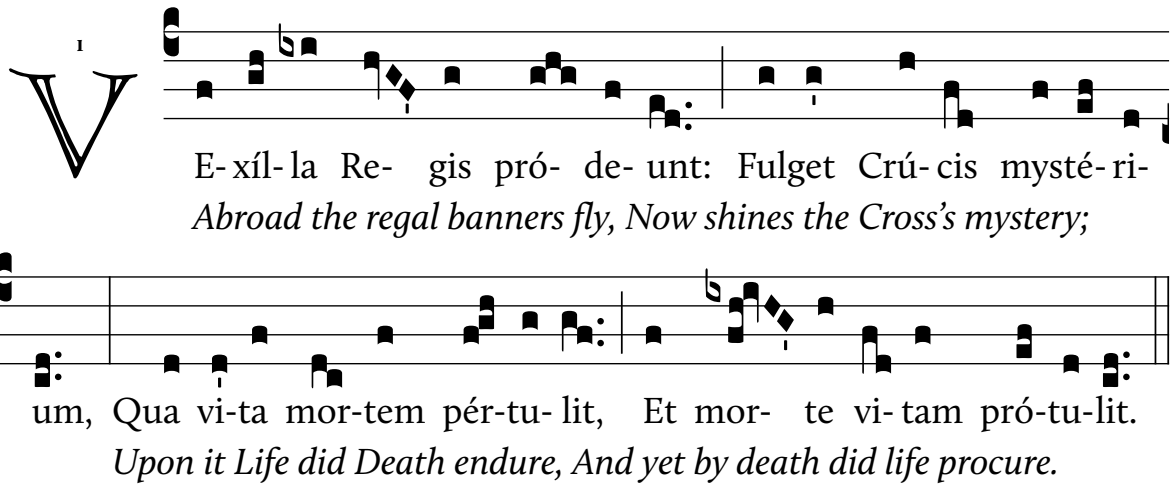


Vexilla Regis



E-xíl-la Re- gis pró- de- unt: Fulget Crú- cis mysté- ri-
Abroad the regal banners fly, Now shines the Cross's mystery;

um, Qua vi-ta mor-tem pér-tu-lit, Et mor- te vi-tam pró-tu-lit.
Upon it Life did Death endure, And yet by death did life procure.

2 . Quae vulneráta lánceæ
 Mucrónē diro, críminum
 Ut nos laváret sórdibus,
 Manávit unda et sáanguine.

2. Who, wounded with a direful spear,
 Did, purposely to wash us clear
 From stain of sin pour out a flood
 Of precious water mixed with blood.

3 . Impléta sunt quæ cóncinit
 David fidéli cármine,
 Dicéndo natió nibus:
 Regnávit a ligno Deus.

3. That which the prophet-king of old
 Hath in mysterious verse foretold,
 Is now accomplished, whilst we see
 God ruling nations from a Tree.

4 . Arbor decóra et fúlgida,
 Ornáta Regis púrpura,
 Elécta digno stípíte
 Tam sancta membra tángere.

4. O lovely and refulgent Tree,
 Adorned with purpled majesty;
 Culled from a worthy stock, to bear
 Those limbs which sanctifiéd were.

5 . Beáta, cujus bráchiis
 Prétium pepéndit sáeculi:
 Statéra facta córporis,
 Tulítque prædam tártari.

5. Blest Tree, whose happy branches bore
 The wealth that did the world restore;
 The beam that did the Body weigh
 Which raised up hell's expected prey.

6 . O Crux ave, spes única,
 Hoc Passiόνis témpore* :
 Piis adáuge grátiam,
 Reisque dele crímina.

6. Hail Cross, of hopes the most sublime!
 Now, in this mournful Passion time;
 Grant to the just increase of grace,
 And every sinner's crimes efface.

7 . Te, fons salútis Trínitas,
 Colláudet omnis spíritus :
 Quibus Crucis victóriam
 Largíris, adde præmium.
 Amen.

7. Blest Trinity, salvation's spring
 May every soul Thy praises sing;
 To those Thou grantest conquest by
 The holy Cross, rewards supply.
 Amen

** Alternative verse for outside Passiontide:*

6 . O Crux ave, spes única,
In hac triúmphi glória * :
Piis adáuge grátiam,
Reísque dele crímina.

6. Hail Cross, our Hope, on Thee we call,
In this triumphant festival,
Grant to the just increase of grace,
And every sinner's crimes efface.

℣. Hoc sígnum in Crúcis érit in cáelo.
This sign of the Cross shall be in heaven.
℟. Cum Dóminus ad judicándum vénerit.
When the Lord shall come to judgement.

Venantius Fortunatus 530–609
Translated by W. K. Blount, d. 1717

O Sacred Head sore wounded

○ SACRED HEAD! sore wounded,
With grief and shame
weighed down,
O Kingly Head! surrounded
With thorns, Thy only crown;
Death's pallor now comes o'er Thee,
The glow of life decays,
Yet hosts of heaven adore Thee
And tremble as they gaze.

2. What language shall I borrow
To thank Thee, dearest Friend,
For this Thy dying sorrow,
Thy pity without end?
O agony and dying!
O love to sinners free!
Jesus, all grace supplying,
Turn Thou Thy face on me.

3. In this thy bitter passion
Sweet Jesus, think of me.
With thy most sweet compassion,
Unworthy though I be:
Beneath thy cross abiding
Forever would I rest,
In thy dear love confiding,
And with thy presence blest.

4. Be thou my consolation,
My shield, when I must die;
Remind me of thy passion
When my last hour draws nigh.
Mine eyes shall then behold thee;
Upon thy cross shall dwell,
My heart by faith enfold thee;
Who dieth thus, dies well.

Paul Gerhardt 1607–76 from *Salve caput cruentatum*
attrib. Bernard of Clairvaux
tr. Henry Williams Baker 1821–77 and
James Waddell Alexander 1804–59